Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets

By J.K. Rowling

RIDDLE: Twice-in your past, in my future-we have met. And twice I've failed to kill you. *How did you survive?* Tell me everything. The longer you talk the longer you stay alive."

INTRODUCTION

Harry Potter defeated the dark Lord Voldemort at the age of only a year. Now he is 12 and is facing his second year at Hogwart's School of Witchcraft and Wizardry. There have been attacks petrifying students, all over the school. No one knows who's committing these attacks until Harry Potter uncovers the mystery of The Chamber of Secrets by J.K Rowling.

"Tom-*Tom Riddle?*" Harry stared at him. Tom Riddle had been at Hogwarts 50 years ago, yet here he stood not a day older than 16. "Are you a ghost?"

4NG Fanatics

"A memory preserved in a diary for 50 years." Riddle pointed toward the floor. Lying open there was the little black diary Harry had found. "I've waited a long time for this Harry Potter, for the chance to speak to you."

"What's happened to Ginny?"

"Well, that's an interesting question, and quite a long story. I suppose the real reason Ginny Weasley's missing is because she opened her heart and spilled all her secrets to an invisible stranger."

"What are you talking about?"

"The diary, *my* diary. Little Ginny's been writing in it for months and months, telling me all her pitiful worries and woes. It's very *boring* having to listen to the silly troubles of an eleven-year-old girl. Yet Ginny simply *loved* me. *No one's ever understood me like you Tom. . . . I'm so glad I've got this diary to confide in. . . . It's like*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

having a friend I can carry around in my pocket. . . . So Ginny poured out her soul, and her soul happened to be exactly what I wanted. . . . I grew stronger and stronger on a diet of her deepest fears, her darkest secrets. I grew powerful.

Powerful enough to start feeding Miss Weasley a few of *my* secrets, to start pouring a little of my soul back into *her*. . ."

"What d'you mean?"

Ginny Weasley opened the Chamber of Secrets. She daubed threatening messages on the walls. She set the serpent of Slytherin on four mud bloods. Of course she didn't *know* what she was doing at first. It was very amusing. I wish you could have seen her new diary entrees . . . far more interesting they became. . . . *Dear Tom, I think I'm loosing my memory, There was an attack today and I don't know where I was. Tom, what am I going to do? I think I'm going mad. . . .* It took a very long time for stupid little Ginny to stop trusting her diary, but she finally became suspicious and tried to dispose of it, and that's where you came in, Harry. Of all the people who could have picked it up, it was *you*, the very person I was most anxious to meet. . . ."

4NG Fanatics

"And why did you want to meet me?"

"Well you see, Ginny told me all about you, Harry, your whole *fascinating* history. I knew I must find out more about you, meet you if I could. So I mad you think that great oaf Hagrid opened the chamber. As though Hagrid had the brains or the power! It had taken *me* five whole years to find the secret entrance to the chamber. "I knew it wouldn't be safe to open the Chamber again while I was still at school. But I wasn't going to waste those long years I spent searching for it. I decided to leave behind a diary, preserving my sixteen-year-old self in its pages, so that one day, with luck, I would be able to lead another in my footsteps, and finish Salazar Slytherin's noble work."

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

"Well you haven't finished it. No one's died this time."

"Killing mud bloods doesn't matter to me anymore. For many months now my new target has been-*you*. I knew what I must do. I made Ginny write her own farewell on the wall and come down here to wait. She struggled and cried and became *very* boring. But there isn't much life left in her. . . . She put too much into the diary, into me. Enough to let me leave its pages at last. . . . I have been waiting for you to appear. I know you would come. I have many questions for you, Harry Potter."

"Like what?"

"Well, how is it that *you*- a skinny boy with no extraordinary magical talent-managed to defeat the greatest wizard of all time? How did you escape with nothing but a scar, while Lord Voldemort's powers were destroyed?"

4NG Fanatics

"Why do you care how I escaped? Voldemort was after your time. . . ."

"Voldemort, is my past present and future, Harry Potter. . . ." He pulled his wand from his pocket and began to trace it through the air, writing three shimmering words:

TOM MARVOLO RIDDLE

The he waved the wand once and the letters of his name rearranged themselves:

I AM LORD VOLDEMORT

"You see Harry? I fashioned myself a new name, a name I knew wizards everywhere would one day fear to speak, when I had become the greatest sorcerer in the world!"

Harry's brain seemed to have jammed. He stared numbly at Riddle, at the orphaned boy who had grown up to murder Harry's own parents, and so many others.

"To business, Harry. Twice- in *your* past, in *my* future-we have met. And twice I've failed to kill you.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

How did you survive? Tell me everything. The longer you talk, the longer you stay alive."

Harry was thinking fast, weighing his chances. It looked bad, but if it had to be a fight between him and Riddle, better sooner than later.

"No one knows why you lost your powers when you attacked me. I don't know myself. But I know why you couldn't *kill* me, because my mother died to save me. My common *muggle-born* mother. She stopped you killing me. And now, you're a wreck, you're barely alive. That's where all your power got you. You're in hiding, you're ugly, you're foul!"

"So, your mother died to save you. Yes, that's a powerful counter charm. I can see now . . . There's nothing special about you after all. Now, Harry, I'm going to teach you a lesson. Let's match the powers of Lord Voldemort, heir of Salazar Slytherin, against famous Harry Potter."

4NG Fanatics

Then Harry noticed it-the diary. Then without thinking, without considering, as though he meant to do it all along, Harry seized a snake fang off the floor and plunged it straight into the heart of the book. There was a long, dreadful, piercing scream. Ink sputtered out of the diary in torrents, streaming over Harry's hands, flooding the floor. Riddle was writhing and twisting, screaming and flailing and then- He was gone, and there was silence. Silence except for the steady *drip drip* of ink still oozing from the diary.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: J.K. Rowling
ISBN: 978-0439064873
Publisher: Scholastic, Inc
Date (Month/Year): Aug 2000

AWARD HISTORY

2002 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY